

The Evolution of Nursing

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Chapter 1: four ideas to connect

History and education

Trace how caregiving became a regulated profession and how formal education strengthened safe, consistent care.

Practical nursing

Connect licensure, education, and supervision with the practical nurse's role on the care team.

Care delivery systems

Recognize where care is provided and how patients move across settings and team members.

Roles and responsibilities

Link scope of practice with direct care, observation, reporting, documentation, and teaching reinforcement.

Put the chapter into safe practical nursing care

Professional identity begins with safe habits.

Arrive prepared, protect confidentiality, communicate respectfully, and accept feedback. Know which tasks you may perform, which require supervision, and when a change in condition must be reported.

- ✓ Verify your assigned role
- ✓ Prepare before care
- ✓ Observe the patient closely
- ✓ Document what you did
- ✓ Ask before acting when unsure

RECOGNIZE → ACT → REPORT

Know your role.
Notice the change.
Ask before proceeding.

Before moving on, explain the cue, your immediate action within scope, and the facts you would report.